1 Wealth Inequality

1.1 Introduction to the Wealth Inequality Section

The Wealth Inequality section presents a large comprehensive compilation of cross-national time-series data on wealth inequality. This section contains wealth inequality indicators (such as top shares and Gini coefficients) for many countries, as estimated in the existing literature and as derived from existing micro data sources. These data are accompanied by Methodological Tables that provide systematic assessments of the underlying concepts, methods, and sources for the estimation of wealth inequality trends. This section provides access to, and detailed information about, wealth inequality across countries and over time. To date, there is no comprehensive database that offers off the shelf indicators on wealth inequality levels and trends for a variety of different sources. Estimates of wealth distributions are much less settled than those of income distributions, and there is substantial controversy about how wealth inequality has evolved in recent years. A core value-added of this section is that users have access to detailed information about the values provided and methodological information that will help them to navigate the inevitable complexity. Users can also exploit our classification of data types, source types, and units of analysis to guide the choice of the most suitable indicator for their purpose.

1.2 The Structure of the Wealth Inequality Section

In the Wealth Inequality database, each estimate of wealth inequality (`value`) is uniquely identified by the combination of the reference country indexed by a two-digit identifier (`GEO`) and the country name (`GEO_long`), the reference year (`year`), the data source (`source`), the `varcode`, and a `percentile`.

Table 1 provides a small extract from the Wealth Inequality database. This table displays data sourced from the HFCS for Austria in the year 2010. The series reported in the `value` column correspond to an inequality indicator (`varcode`) calculated across various percentiles (`percentile`). Specifically, the `varcode` column provides details about the unit of analysis and the type of wealth inequality measure, while the `percentile` column indicates which segment of the distribution the estimate pertains to. The subsequent sections elaborate on the variables `varcode` and `percentile`

1.3 The `varcode` in the Wealth Inequality Section

In the Wealth Inequality section, two of the five elements of `varcode` are fixed across the entire database. The constant elements are the first, that identifies the Section of the GC Wealth Project and takes the value `t`, , and the second, that indexes the household sector and takes the value `hs`. The `Variable Type`, the `Concept`, and the `Section-Specific` parts of the `varcode` vary within a source and across sources and are explained in detail in what follows. Hence, `varcode` takes the following form:

$$\underbrace{t}_{\text{Section}} - \underbrace{hs}_{\text{Sector}} - \underbrace{CCC}_{\text{Variable Type}} - \underbrace{DDDDDD}_{\text{Concept}} - \underbrace{ZZ}_{\text{Section-Specific}}$$

Table 1: Introducing the GC Wealth Inequality Database - Snippet

source	GEO	GEO_long	year	varcode	percentile	value
HFCS_ineq	AT	Austria	2010	t-hs-dsh-netwea-ho	p0p10	-0.7607081
HFCS_ineq	AT	Austria	2010	t-hs-dsh-netwea-ho	p0p100	100.0000000
HFCS_ineq	AT	Austria	2010	t-hs-dsh-netwea-ho	p0p20	-0.7040209
HFCS_ineq	AT	Austria	2010	t-hs-dsh-netwea-ho	p0p25	-0.6078429
HFCS_ineq	AT	Austria	2010	t-hs-dsh-netwea-ho	p0p30	-0.4479540
HFCS_ineq	AT	Austria	2010	t-hs-dsh-netwea-ho	p0p40	0.2309287
HFCS_ineq	AT	Austria	2010	t-hs-dsh-netwea-ho	p0p50	2.0814364
HFCS_ineq	AT	Austria	2010	t-hs-dsh-netwea-ho	p0p60	6.2014584
HFCS_ineq	AT	Austria	2010	t-hs-dsh-netwea-ho	p0p70	12.9382315
HFCS_ineq	AT	Austria	2010	t-hs-dsh-netwea-ho	p0p80	22.8109970
HFCS_ineq	AT	Austria	2010	t-hs-dsh-netwea-ho	p0p90	38.6638222
HFCS_ineq	AT	Austria	2010	t-hs-dsh-netwea-ho	p0p99	77.0243073
HFCS_ineq	AT	Austria	2010	t-hs-dsh-netwea-ho	p50p90	36.5823860
HFCS_ineq	AT	Austria	2010	t-hs-dsh-netwea-ho	p75p100	82.6313934
HFCS_ineq	AT	Austria	2010	t-hs-dsh-netwea-ho	p80p100	77.1890030
HFCS_ineq	AT	Austria	2010	t-hs-dsh-netwea-ho	p90p100	61.3361778
HFCS_ineq	AT	Austria	2010	t-hs-dsh-netwea-ho	p90p95	13.7213869
HFCS_ineq	AT	Austria	2010	t-hs-dsh-netwea-ho	p90p99	38.3604889
HFCS_ineq	AT	Austria	2010	t-hs-dsh-netwea-ho	p95p100	47.6147919
HFCS_ineq	AT	Austria	2010	t-hs-dsh-netwea-ho	p95p99	24.6391010
HFCS_ineq	AT	Austria	2010	t-hs-dsh-netwea-ho	p99p100	22.9756908

Table 2: Wealth Inequality: Variable Type

Code	Label	Description
dsh	Share of Total Net Wealth	The share of a given asset (or assets group) on total net wealth. For instance, we may refer to the overall net wealth (or any given asset, i.e. housing, financial assets, debt) that individuals, household, or group owns as a share of total net wealth. For example, if the total net wealth of a country is €10,000 billion and a group's net wealth is €2,000 billion, their share of total net wealth would be 20%. Moreover, if half of this group's wealth is held in housing wealth, their distributional share of housing would be 10%.
owr	Ownership Rate	The proportion of households or individuals who self-report owning a specific asset or good. Calculated as the number of households (or individuals) reporting ownership divided by the total number of households (or individuals) in the reference population.
gin	Gini Coefficient	The Gini coefficient is a statistic that summarizes the overall distribution of income or wealth that is commonly published by statistical agencies. The coefficient ranges from 0 (perfect equality) to 100 (maximum inequality). A Gini coefficient of G per cent means that, if we take any 2 households from the population at random, the expected difference is 2G per cent of the mean. So that a rise in the Gini coefficient from 30 to 40 per cent implies that the expected difference (in wealth for instance) has gone up from 60 to 80 per cent of the average wealth.
avg	Average Wealth	Average wealth refers to the total value of assets (such as property, savings, investments, and other financial assets) owned by a group of individuals or households divided by the total number of individuals or households in that group.
thr	Threshold	A threshold represents a minimum or maximum value that must be met or exceeded, for instance, the minimum value of net wealth that is needed for an individual to belong to the group of the richest 1% of adults, or the maximum value of net wealth that is needed for an individual to belong to the group of the poorest 50% of adults.
tot	Total	It represents the total value of a variable. For instance, total population, or total revenue raised from the inheritance tax.

1.3.1 `Variable Type`

The third element of the `varcode` identifies the broad type of inequality measure. Table 2 provides the permitted strings of the `Variable Type` within the `varcode` in the Inequality Trends database, together with a label and a description. Note that data on monetary units (averages, thresholds, and totals) are always shown in national currency, in nominal term with no adjustment to inflation. The supplementary variables (see Section **??**) could be used to transform all monetary values into other currencies and to adjust for inflation dynamics.

1.3.2 `Concept`

The fourth element of the `varcode` identifies the `Concept`. In the Wealth Inequality database, a concept is the asset category the indicator refers to. The nomenclature and definitions are borrowed from the Wealth Topography Section and detailed in Table 3. The Table reports the concepts and the corresponding identifiers used in the `varcode` of the Wealth Inequality database, together with a detailed description and the list of available `Variable Type` associated with each concept. For example, with respect to total net wealth (`netwea`), the available indicators include averages (`avg`), shares (`dsh`), thresholds (`thr`), and totals (`tot`) held by different segments of the distribution (further specified by the variable `percentile`), as well as overall Gini (`gin`) estimates.

Table 3: Wealth Inequality: Concept Dictionary

Code	Label	Var Type
netwea	Net Wealth	dsh, thr, gin, avg, tot
nnhass	Financial Assets & Fixed Capital of Personal Businesses	avg, dsh, tot, owr
nfahou	Housing & Land	avg, dsh, tot, owr
fliabi	Debt	avg, dsh, tot, owr
fadepb	Bank accounts	owr
fadepo	Deposits	owr
faeqfd	Stocks, Business Equities & Fund Shares	owr
falipe	Pensions & Life Insurance	owr
nfaala	Agricultural Land	owr
nfabus	Fixed Capital of Personal Businesses	owr
nfadur	Durable Goods	avg, dsh, tot
nfhous	Housing	owr

Table 4: Wealth Inequality: Section-Specific

Code	Label	Description
ia	Individuals - Adults	Estimates of wealth inequality refer to the distribution across individual holders (depending on the source, at least 15, 16, 18, or 20 years old). In rare cases, this label also refers to individuals assumed to be holding the equivalized wealth of the household. The equivalence scale used in most cases is the "modified OECD scale,", which gives a weight of 1 to the first adult, of 0.5 to each additional adult, and of 0.3 to each child. This means that total wealth of a family of 2 adults and 2 children is divided by 2.1. In other rare cases, it refers to the distribution across all individuals, irrespective of their age.
es	Individuals - Adults (equal split)	Total wealth of the household is divided equally between the two adult partners. Adults are generally defined as individuals at least 18 or 20 years old. This category could also include cases in which total wealth of the household is divided equally among all members of the household.
tu	Tax Units	Data on wealth holding refer to a group of individuals who are subject to the same tax laws (tax unit). In most cases, a tax unit is composed of one or more people who file a tax return together, such as a married couple filing jointly or a family filing as dependents on a parent's tax return.
ho	Households	Data on wealth holding refer to a household, defined as a group of people who live together in the same dwelling unit. The members of a household may be related by blood, marriage, or adoption, or they may be unrelated individuals who have chosen to live together for other reasons.

1.3.3 `Section-Specific`

In the Wealth Inequality database, the section-specific part of the `varcode` refers to the unit of analysis of the wealth inequality indicator. The databases distinguishes four types of units of analysis: individual adults (`ia`), individual adults with equal split (`es`), tax units (`tu`), and households (`ho`). The list of permitted strings and a short description is provided in Table 4.

1.4 The `percentile` variable in the Wealth Inequality Section

In addition to the `varcode`, values are indexed by the `percentile` variable. This variable identifies the reference segment of the net wealth distribution for each inequality indicator. In particular it specifies the lower-bound and the upper-bound percentiles delimiting the reference group. For the share of wealth held by the richest 1%, for instance, the `percentile` variable corresponds to *p99p100*. If the index refers to the overall population, as in the case of the overall net wealth or the Gini index, the `percentile` variable corresponds to *p0p100*. We provide a selection of permitted percentiles in Table 5; the full list can be found in the `dictionary.xlsx`.

Table 5: Wealth Inequality: Selected Percentiles

Code	Label	Description
p0p10	Poorest 10%	Group representing the bottom decile (10%) of the wealth distribution, meaning that 90% of the population would have higher wealth levels in comparison.
p0p100	Overall Population	Everyone in the reference population
p90p99	Next 9% (90th-99th Percentiles)	Group with wealth level higher than the top decile but not high enough to enter the group of the richest 1 % in the population
p99.999p100	Richest 0.001%	Group representing the richest 0.001% of the wealth distribution
p99p100	Richest 1%	Group representing the top percentile (1%) of the wealth distribution, meaning that 99% of the population would have lower wealth levels in comparison.

1.5 Construction of the Wealth Inequality Section

The procedure used to construct the Wealth Inequality database is outlined in Figure 1. First, we identify the relevant sources and obtain the raw data. Second, we transform and harmonize the raw data to fit our standards in terms of format and structure. Third, we run a set of tests and append the source-specific estimates to the database. Concurrently, we develop and write a detailed **Methodological Table**.

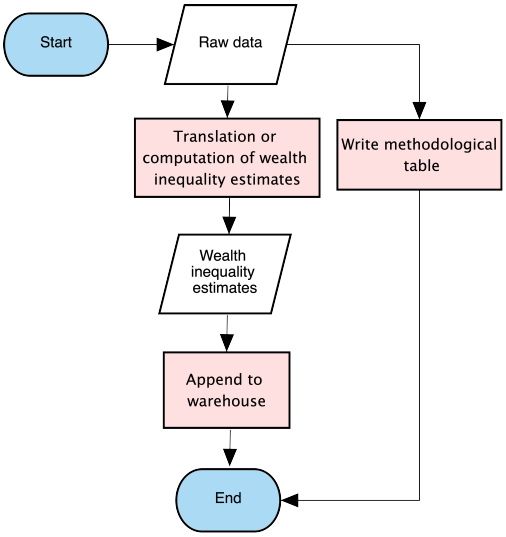


Figure 1: Wealth Inequality Workflow

1.5.1 Step 1: Identification and Classilfication of Sources

The starting point is the identification of relevant data on wealth inequality estimates. These estimates can originate from different *types* of sources, like academic, government, and corporate research, as well as cross-national research and official statistics. Table 6 provides an overview of the permitted types of source.

Table 6: Wealth Inequality: Source Types

Label	Description
Cross-national official statistics	Cross-national data from official institutions, such as national accounts from central banks.
Cross-national official survey data	Cross-national survey data from official institutions, such as household finance surveys from national statistical offices.
Cross-national corporate research	Cross-national research published by corporate entities, such as private consultancy firms.
Cross-national academic research	Cross-national research published by academic institutions, such as an academic journal article.
Cross-national government research	Cross-national research published by government institutions, such as government-commissioned reports.
Official statistics	Data from official institutions, such as national accounts from a country's central bank.
Official survey data	Survey data from official institutions, such as household finance surveys from a country's national statistical office.
Corporate research	Research published by corporate entities, such as private consultancy firms.
Academic research	Research published by academic institutions, such as an academic journal article.
Government research	Research published by government institutions, such as government-commissioned reports.
Government legislation	The actual text of public legislation.
Government legislative info	Texts published by government institutions that provide descriptive information about public legislation, such as a government website explaining tax clauses.
Government documents	Other texts published by government institutions, such as tax documents, forms, or descriptive reports.

Each source estimates inequality indicators using different types of data, such as household surveys, administrative data, and national accounts. To track these differences, we categorize each source according to the type of data used, as detailed in the taxonomy listed in Table 7.

As the data type classification is source-specific, the exercise of assigning a type to each source turns out to be less precise for cross-national sources, as we do not differentiate across countries specificities within the same source. For instance, in the case of the Luxembourg Wealth Study Database [4] and the OECD Wealth Distribution Database [5], we classify the data type as *Household survey*. However, data for one country, Norway, does not come from a wealth survey but from various administrative sources. Similarly, we classify the World Inequality Database [10] as a *Mix of sources and methods* to reflect the variety of data sources and estimation methods underlying this source. All these details features in the source-specific **Methodological Table**.

Eventually, once the relevant source is identified and correctly classified, we acquire the raw data.

For sources classified as Cross-national official survey data, we produce our own estimates starting from micro data. In these cases, only the resulting statistics are made available in the warehouse, without releasing the underlying micro data. The code to produce the estimates for each source from the raw micro data is publicly

Table 7: Data Type

Label	Description
Household survey	The series has been estimated using only household survey data.
Wealth survey	The series has been estimated using only wealth survey data.
Household survey (with adjustments)	The series has been estimated from household survey data that has been adjusted, especially at the top. Adjustment methods comprise rich-list based adjustment als well as pure reweighting methods.
Household survey and national accounts	The series has been estimated using houehold survey data that has been brought into alignment with macroeconomic balance sheets.
Rich list	The series has been estimated using only rich list data points.
Capital income tax data, household survey, and national accounts	The series has been estimated via a capitalization approach that uses data on income due to the ownership of wealth (capital income), supported by survey data, and the series aligns with macroeconomic balance sheets.
Capital income tax data, other sources, and national accounts	The series has been estimated via a capitalization approach that uses data on income due to the ownership of wealth (capital income), additional data other than household survey data, and the series aligns with macroeconomic balance sheets.
Inheritance/estate tax-based	The series has been estimated via a mortality-multiplier approach using inheritance and/or estate tax data.
Inheritance/estate tax data, household survey, and national accounts	The series has been estimated via a mortality-multiplier approach using inheritance and/or estate tax data, supported by survey data, and the corresponding aggregates align with macroeconomic balance sheets.
Wealth tax/register-based	The series has been estimated from wealth tax data or register data on wealth.
Wealth tax/register data and estate tax data	The series has been estimated from wealth tax data or register data on wealth used in conjunction with estate/inheritance tax data.
Wealth tax/register data, other sources, and national accounts	The series has been estimated from wealth tax data or register data on wealth in conjunction with additional sources other than estate/inheritance tax data, and it has been brought into alignment with macroeconomic balance sheets.
Mix of sources and methods	Any series that rely substantively on a combination of sources and methods and that cannot be listed under any of the other classifications.

available. Researchers interested in replicating the estimates we provide, should independently request access to the raw micro data from the original data provider. These sources are: Demographic and Health Surveys [7], Global Findex Database [2], WAEMU Harmonized Household Living Conditions Surveys [9], Household Finance and Consumption Survey [3], Living Standards Measurement Study [8], and Luxembourg Wealth Study Database [4]. For all other sources, we use the raw data as published.

1.5.2 Step 2: Transformation and Harmonization of Raw Data

The published raw data may come in various shapes or formats, including .pdf documents, and .xlsx or .csv files. Therefore, we need to process this information and harmonize the source-specific series to conform to the warehouse standards. This involves assigning each data point (`value`) with relevant information, including its data source (`source`), reference year (`year`), country code (`GEO`, `GEO_long`), type of inequality indicator (`varcode`), and the percentiles of the distribution it represents (`percentile`). This procedure ensures a consistent data structure across all sources. If feasible, we derive additional indicators from the available data. For example, if a source provides estimates for the wealth share of the richest 1% (p99p100) and the wealth share of the richest 10% (p90p100), we calculate the wealth share of the Next 9% (90th–99th percentiles) based on these estimates. It is important to note that when a source provides multiple estimates for the same inequality series, we select only one of these values, typically the benchmark estimate as defined in the underlying research paper or database. In future releases of the GC Wealth Project, we aim to explore the within-source variation of wealth inequality estimates by incorporating the full range of estimates that reflect different methodological assumptions. Finally, the current version of the Wealth Inequality database does not publish fully imputed estimates of wealth inequality. An estimate is defined as fully imputed if no wealth distribution data was used in the estimation of wealth inequality indicators for a specific country. Wealth distribution data may derive directly from micro-level data or from databases that publish wealth inequality measures estimated on the basis of micro data. This definition implies that the database still includes time series in which wealth distribution data has been used only in one or selected years, with missing years filled through interpolation. This has implications for a handful of sources, such as Credit Suisse [1] and the World Inequality Database [10], which are discussed in the Appendix (Section **??**).

1.5.3 Step 3: Testing and Appending

After making sure the acquired, derived, and estimated wealth inequality indicators follow our formatting standards, we run a set of consistency checks and tests before we append them to the Wealth Inequality database.

1.6 Methodological Tables

The **Methodological Tables** summarize for each source, among other things: the type of data used, where the work sources its data, the unit of analysis, the methods of estimation, how different assets are valued, how specific types of assets are treated, any adjustments made to the data, important underlying assumptions, and more. We provide a brief description of the content of the **Methodological Tables** in Table 8.

Table 8: Methodological Tables - Content Description

Field name	Field description
Legend	The name of the source.
Period covered and data points	The range from the first to last year included in the series published in the warehouse; the precise years and/or quarters for which data points are available; the total number of years and/or quarters containing data points.
Data type	A categorization of the data type(s) used in the series published in the warehouse.
Inequality indicators	The precise inequality measures covered in the series. See the description of the varcode (vartype) for more information on these measures.
Data sources used in the research	A list of all data sources used in the estimation of wealth inequality and the year(s) they provide data for. Note that not all of these data sources are necessarily relevant to the specific series we publish in the database. Full citation information for these sources is not typically included in the references section, and should instead be located from the source itself.
Unit of analysis	The unit of analysis of the series published in the warehouse. See the description of the varcode (dashboard-specific) for details.
Definition of wealth	The precise definition of wealth underlying the wealth inequality estimates provided by the source.
Method of estimation	A brief summary of the estimation method of the series published in the warehouse.
Method of estimation (detailed)	A more detailed explanation (when applicable) of the estimation method of the series published in the warehouse.
Valuation of assets	How specific assets and liabilities have been valuated.
Treatment of private pensions	Whether any private pensions are included in the wealth definition, and if applicable, how they have been valuated.
Treatment of public pensions	Whether any public pensions are included in the wealth definition, and if applicable, how they have been valuated.
Treatment of life insurance	Whether any life insurance benefits are included in the wealth definition, and if applicable, how they have been valuated.
Treatment of household and personal goods (e.g., vehicles, boats, aircraft, jewelry, antiques, works of art, collections)	Whether any valuables and consumer goods are included in the definition of wealth, and if applicable, how they have been valuated.
Treatment of foreign wealth holdings	Whether any assets held abroad are included in the wealth definition, and if applicable, how they have been valuated.
Treatment of debt	Which types of liabilities are included in the wealth definition, and if applicable, how they have been valuated.
Adjustments to data	An explanation of any significant adjustments made to the raw data.
Distributional estimates aligned with national account aggregates	Whether the wealth estimate has been brought into alignment with the reference country's national accounts wealth aggregates.
Total population estimate and source	The manner and source of the reference population estimate underlying the series.
Total wealth estimate and source	The manner and source of the aggregate wealth estimate underlying the series.
References	A bibliography for the sources cited parenthetically in the table's analysis (i.e., not necessarily those listed in the data sources used in the research section). Any important references that are called out by title in the analysis (such as appendices, data files, or a working paper version of the source) are listed first, with their reference information and any downloadable files being available at their hyperlinked entry in the Data Sources Library.

1.7 Wealth Inequality Section — Innovative Features of Version 2.0 of the Warehouse

Version 2.0 of the Wealth Inequality section introduces two innovations with respect to earlier versions of the warehouse: the Distributional Topography module and the Asset and Liability Ownership Rates module.

1.7.1 The Distributional Topography Module

The Distributional Topography module aims to provide estimates of wealth portfolios across the net wealth distribution. Rather than focusing solely on aggregate inequality indicators, this module documents how the composition of assets and liabilities varies across different segments of the distribution, offering a more granular picture of wealth structures.

The module builds on the Distributional Wealth Accounts published by the European Central Bank [@ EuropeanCentralBank2024_DistributionalWealthAccounts] and on the Distributional Financial Accounts published by the Federal Reserve (FED) [6], which both provide breakdowns of asset holdings by position in the wealth distribution. We complement and extend these estimates by integrating micro data from the Luxembourg Wealth Study Database (LWS) [4] and the Household Finance and Consumption Survey (HFCS) [3], thereby broadening both the country coverage and the level of detail potentially available.

To ensure comparability across sources, we decompose the net wealth (`varcode` concept `netwea`) held by different wealth sub-populations into Financial Assets & Fixed Capital of Personal Businesses (`nnhass`), Housing & Land (`nfahou`), where available durables (`nfadur`), and Debt (`fliabi`). For each of these assets and liabilities, we provide averages (`avg`), totals (`tot`), and assets shares on total net wealth (`dsh`) held by the sub-group of the population indicated in the variable `percentile`. As in the rest of the warehouse, data on monetary units (averages and totals) are always shown in national currency, in nominal terms with no adjustment for inflation. The supplementary variables (see Section **??**) can be used to transform all monetary values into other currencies and to adjust for inflation.

To better illustrate the functioning of the module, Table 9 presents a selection of estimates from the Distributional Topography module for Italy (IT) in 2024, sourced from the ECB Distributional Wealth Accounts (ECB_DWA_ineq). All observations refer to the bottom 50% of the wealth distribution (p0p50), with households as the unit of analysis (ho).

Table 9: Distributional Topography: Italy 2022, ECB DWA, Bottom 50%

Varcode	Percentile	Value
t-hs-avg-fliabi-ho	p0p50	-23740.000
t-hs-avg-netwea-ho	p0p50	63950.000
t-hs-avg-nfahou-ho	p0p50	64350.000
t-hs-avg-nnhass-ho	p0p50	23330.000
t-hs-dsh-fliabi-ho	p0p50	-2.770
t-hs-dsh-netwea-ho	p0p50	7.463
t-hs-dsh-nfahou-ho	p0p50	7.511
t-hs-dsh-nnhass-ho	p0p50	2.722

The varcode follows the structure `t-hs-[Variable Type]-[Concept]-ho`. Two variable types are shown: averages (`avg`) and shares (`dsh`). For each, net wealth (`netwea`) is decomposed into Housing & Land (`nfahou`), Financial Assets & Fixed Capital of Personal Businesses (`nnhass`), and Debt (`fliabi`).

For example, the row with `varcode t-hs-avg-netwea-ho` indicates that the average net wealth of households in the bottom 50% is 63,950 (in nominal national currency), which can be further decomposed into an average of 64,350 in Housing & Land, 23,330 in Financial Assets & Fixed Capital, and 23,740 in Debt.

Similarly, the row with `varcode t-hs-dsh-netwea-ho` indicates that the net wealth held by households in the bottom 50% of the net wealth distribution amounts to approximately 7.46% of aggregate net wealth.

The corresponding decomposition reveals that the Housing & Land held by this group is worth 7.51% of aggregate net wealth, while their Financial Assets & Fixed Capital of Personal Businesses account for only 2.72% of aggregate net wealth, suggesting that the wealth portfolio of the bottom half is overwhelmingly concentrated in real assets rather than financial ones.

Formally:

$$\text{dsh}_{c,p} = \frac{\text{tot}_{c,p}}{\text{tot}_{\text{netwea, } p0p100}} \times 100 \tag{1}$$

where $c \in \{\text{netwea}, \text{nfahou}, \text{nnhass}, \text{fliabi}\}$ denotes the asset concept, p denotes the percentile group, $\text{tot}_{c,p}$ is the total value of concept c held by the population in percentile group p, and $\text{tot}_{\text{netwea, } p0p100}$ is the aggregate net wealth of the entire population. Note that the within-asset-class share — i.e., the fraction of total concept \$c held by percentile group \$p — can be recovered as:

$$\frac{\text{tot}_{c,p}}{\text{tot}_{c,p0p100}} = \text{dsh}_{c,p} \times \frac{\text{tot}_{netwea,p0p100}}{\text{tot}_{c,p}} \tag{2}$$

1.7.2 The Asset and Liability Ownership Rates module.

The Asset and Liability Ownership Rates module provides survey-based estimates of ownership rates for countries where conventional wealth data are not available. In particular, the module leverages a series of micro data and statistics produced through international programs designed to generate harmonized, cross-nationally comparable data. These programs include the Demographic and Health Surveys Program, the World Bank's Living Standards Measurement Study Program (LSMS) and Global Findex Database, and the joint initiative by of the World Bank and the West Africa Economic and Monetary Union's "Harmonized Survey on Household Living Conditions (EHCVM)". The sources used are: Demographic and Health Surveys [7], WAEMU Harmonized Household Living Conditions Surveys [9], Living Standards Measurement Study [8], and the Global Findex Database [2].

The Asset and Liability Ownership Rates module fills a critical gap in global wealth measurement by providing survey-based estimates of asset ownership rates for countries where conventional wealth data are unavailable. Low and Middle Income countries are typically underrepresented in global analyses of wealth, due to the scarce availability of complete wealth data. In low- and middle-income countries, housing and land are often the most significant assets held by households, especially where financial inclusion remains low. Capturing ownership of these assets, alongside deposits, is therefore an important first step to understanding household wealth in developing economies. Crucially, the inclusion of this module extends the country coverage of the GC wealth Project's data warehouse by 111 countries, significantly expanding the geographic reach of the GC wealth database into low- and middle-income settings.

Table 10 reports, for each source, the country coverage and the core asset classes included in the Wealth Inequality warehouse. To allow for comparisons with countries where richer wealth data are available, we also compute ownership rates from the Luxembourg Wealth Study Database (LWS) [4] and the Household Finance and Consumption Survey (HFCS) [3].

1.8 Additional Information on the Wealth Inequality Section

For additional information about the Wealth Inequality section, we refer the reader the to the Appendix of this Documentation, where we provide a list of all sources included in the Wealth Inequality database, country-specific information on the coverage of the Wealth Inequality database, and additional information on the precise treatment of selected sources.

References

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Table 10: Wealth Inequality: Ownership Rates Sources

Source	Legend	Areas	Concepts
DHS_ineq	Demographic and Health Surveys (own estimates)	AF, AL, AM, AO, AZ, BD, BF, BI, BJ, BO, CD, CG, CI, CM, CO, DO, EG, ET, GA, GH, GM, GN, GT, GY, HN, HT, ID, IN, JO, KE, KG, KH, KM, LR, LS, MA, MD, MG, ML, MM, MR, MV, MW, MZ, NE, NG, NP, PE, PG, PH, PK, RW, SL, SN, ST, SZ, TD, TG, TJ, TL, TR, TZ, UA, UG, YE, ZM, ZW, NA	fadepb, nfaala, nfhous
LSMS_ineq	Living Standards Measurement Study (own estimates)	BF, ET, KH, ML, MW, NE, NG, TZ, UG	fadepb, fadepo, nfaala, nfhous
WAEMU_ineq	WAEMU Harmonized Household Living Conditions Surveys (own estimates)	BF, BJ, CI, GW, ML, NE, SN, TD, TG	fadepb, fadepo, nfaala, nfhous
HFCS_ineq	Household Finance and Consumption Survey (own estimates)	AT, BE, CY, CZ, DE, EE, ES, FI, FR, GR, HR, HU, IE, IT, LT, LU, LV, MT, NL, PL, PT, SI, SK	faeqfd, falipe, fliabi, nfabus, nfahou, nnhass
LWS_ineq	Luxembourg Wealth Study Database (own estimates)	AT, AU, CA, CL, DE, DK, EE, ES, FI, FR, GR, IN, IT, JP, KR, LU, MX, NO, SE, SI, SK, UK, US, ZA	faeqfd, falipe, fliabi, nfabus, nfahou, nnhass
Findex_ineq	Global Findex Database	AE, AF, AL, AM, AO, AR, AT, AU, AZ, BA, BD, BE, BF, BG, BH, BI, BJ, BO, BR, BT, BW, BY, BZ, CA, CD, CF, CG, CH, CI, CL, CM, CN, CO, CR, CY, CZ, DE, DJ, DK, DO, DZ, EC, EE, EG, ES, ET, FI, FR, GA, GE, GH, GM, GN, GR, GT, HK, HN, HR, HT, HU, ID, IE, IL, IN, IQ, IR, IS, IT, JM, JO, JP, KE, KG, KH, KM, KR, KW, KZ, LA, LB, LK, LR, LS, LT, LU, LV, LY, MA, MD, ME, MG, MK, ML, MM, MN, MR, MT, MU, MV, MW, MX, MY, MZ, NE, NG, NI, NL, NO, NP, NZ, OM, PA, PE, PH, PK, PL, PR, PS, PT, PY, QA, RO, RS, RU, RW, SA, SD, SE, SG, SI, SK, SL, SN, SO, SS, SV, SY, SZ, TD, TG, TH, TJ, TM, TN, TR, TT, TW, TZ, UA, UG, UK, US, UY, UZ, VE, VN, XK, YE, ZA, ZM, ZW, NA	fadepo